

Philips DVD Video Digital Surround System MX5700D

Just like the movies

The Philips MX5700D is a five-DVD and CD home entertainment system, comprising five speakers and twin tower sub-woofers plus the main unit. The system plays DVDs, VCDs, SVCDs, DVD+RW, audio CDs, MP3s and mixed mode CDs. An interesting feature is the provision of a media slot that reads MP3s or JPEGs off memory cards using a PCMCIA adapter.

The front two speakers are clipped on to the top of the twin tower sub-woofers. The sleek centre and rear speakers definitely have the flair to add that extra bit to your décor. They are provided with long colour coded wires, making the installation foolproof and fuss-free.

The main unit has five flimsy individual disc trays placed vertically on the left side. Centrally placed is a display-dial for speaker output. The system status dial displays information on active media source, volume level, clock, etc. Next to it are nine buttons that enable one to control various features such as FM tuner, surround sound, playback control, etc. Two large backlit knobs for volume control and source selection are provided at the extreme right.

All standard playback features are available for DVDs, including sub-title selection, slow motion, fast forward, reverse, and title search. Use the media slot to view captured images on the TV directly. You need a 4-in-1 PCMCIA adapter to use Compact Flash (CF), memory stick, Smart Media (SM), Secure Digital (SD) or MultiMedia Cards (MMC) with the system. You can also play MP3 files off memory cards.

Performance-wise, the Philips MX5700D delivers crisp and clear picture quality accompanied by great sound. Though bass is a tad weak, the overall sound quality is great. The MX5700D is a good home entertainment package, especially if you consider its features and ease of use.

■ **Specifications:** 5-DVD/VCD changer, media slot, FM-tuner, Dolby Digital and 7200-watt PMPO surround speakers

■ **Price:** Rs 34,990

■ **Contact:** Philips India Ltd

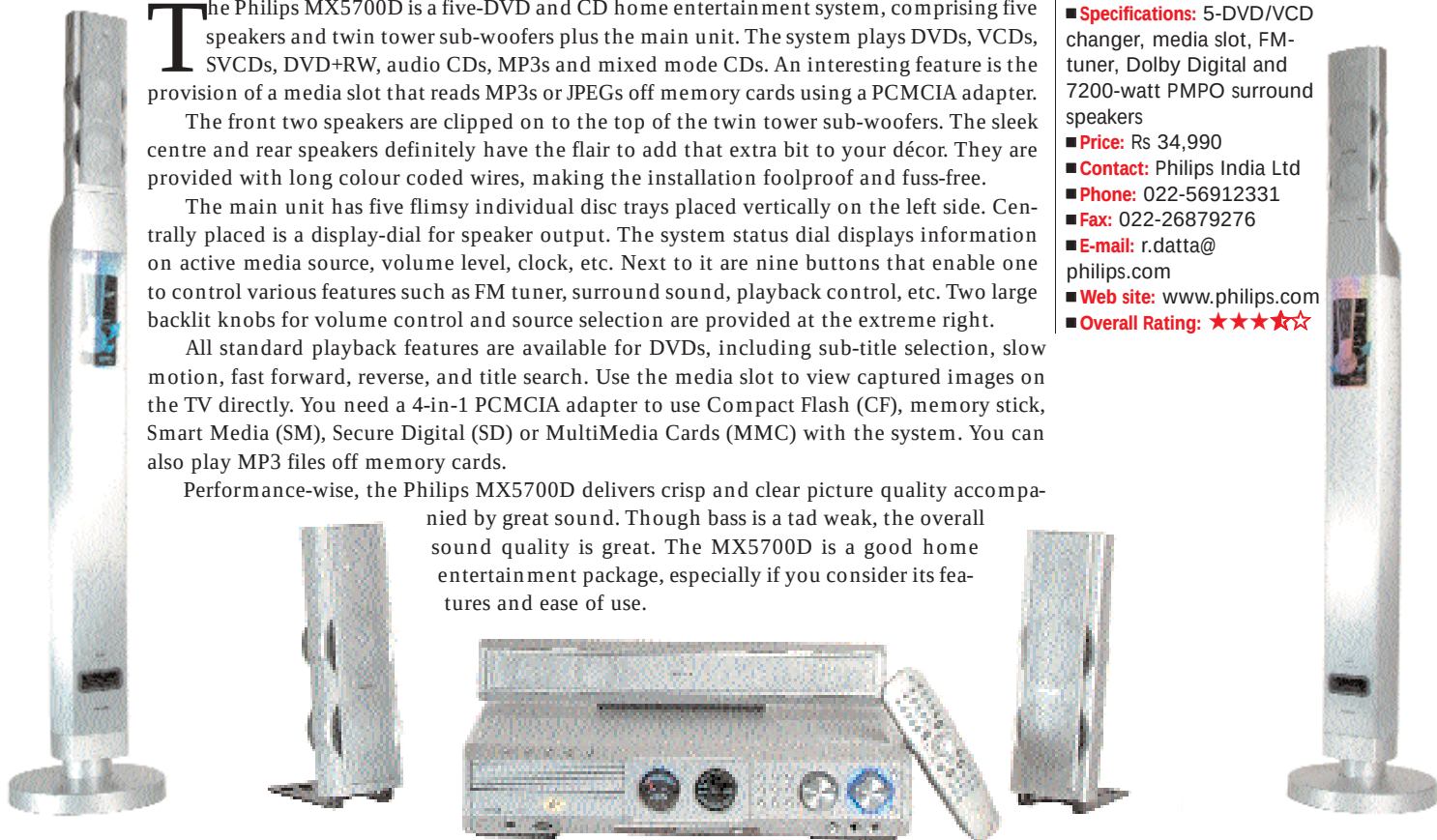
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■ **Overall Rating:** ★★★★★



MSI DR4-A Dual DVD-Writer

Burn those DVDs

The MSI DR4-A DVD writer can write DVD±R, DVD±RW, CD-R and CD-RW, and read them all. Bundled along are the Nero CD-writing software, Sonic MyDVD, PowerDVD, Showbiz video-editing software, an audio cable and manuals.

This drive burns data at the speed of 4X on DVD-R in around 13 minutes, making it a fast burner. Record more than five hours of content on a single DVD that will otherwise take up at least three VCDs. An advantage of DVD media is that movie-quality is much better than on the VCD, since there's more space to fit the content.

The drive burns DVD-RW at 2X. It just took 23 minutes to burn 4.5 GB of data on a DVD+RW, at a speed of 2.4X—23 seconds more than the Lite-On 811s.

The MSI DR4-A Dual Writer erases data just as fast. It wiped data off the DVD+RW in just 24 minutes 6 seconds—36 seconds lesser than the Lite-On 811s.

Affordably priced at Rs 10,000, it makes a good investment if you watch a lot of DVD movies, burn tons of data, archive images and songs and convert camcorder tapes to digital content.

■ **Specifications:** 8 MB buffer, HD-Burn support, EIDE interface, speeds:

CD-RW: 10X, CD-R: 24X, CD-ROM: 40X, DVD: ±R 4X, + RW 2.4X, - RW 2X, DVD-ROM: 12X

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■ **Overall Rating:** ★★★★★

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